HACK876 × THE ATLANTA JAMAICAN ASSOCIATION, INC.

PRIVATE PARTNERSHIP PROPOSAL

From Atlanta, a hand back home.

The AJA has backed students of Jamaican heritage, in Atlanta and in Jamaica, for decades. Hack876 gives Kingston students one day to build something real, and a reason to know the diaspora is cheering them on.

Kingston, Jamaica · Feb 20, 2027 (tentative)



80
STUDENTS

9
SCHOOL NETWORK

1
DAY

One day to build something that should exist.

01 WHAT IS HACK876?

Meet Hack876.



Hack876 is a one-day build competition for approximately **80 secondary-school students** from 5th Form through Upper 6th Form, working in teams of 3 to 4, roughly 20 teams in all, on Saturday, February 20, 2027 (tentative).

Teams pick a real problem, use modern tools including AI, get guidance from mentors, and finish the day with a working prototype and a pitch to judges. It is not a school assignment and there is no answer key.

Our **9-school network** in Kingston is made up of the schools where the Hack876 team currently has relationships and can coordinate most reliably. It is not an exclusive eligibility list.

BUILD SOMETHING THAT SHOULD EXIST.

Roots in Jamaica. Community in Atlanta. Students in both.

Hack876 is a chance for Atlanta's Jamaican community to cheer on students back home on the day they build something of their own.

THE ATLANTA JAMAICAN ASSOCIATION, MISSION

"The mission of the Atlanta Jamaican Association, Inc. (AJA) is to foster goodwill and understanding among Jamaicans and all peoples in metro Atlanta, through civic, economic, cultural, and philanthropic programs and activities; and to provide assistance to Jamaicans living in the area and in Jamaica."[2]

Since 1995, the AJA Scholarship has helped graduating seniors of Jamaican heritage, in metro Atlanta and in Jamaica, with first-year college costs. Over 100 students have received awards.[3]

Since 2016, the AJA has given $200K in scholarships and aid, and more than 150 students have received its help with university studies.[4]

Its outreach to Jamaica has included books, supplies and equipment for basic schools.[5]

Through Rep Yuh Parish, members team up to choose, fund and take part in a community project in the parish they are closest to.[5]

Nearly fifty years of looking after our own.

1977	The Atlanta Jamaican Association is founded on October 8, and is incorporated the next year. Today it is the oldest Jamaican organization in metro Atlanta.[2]
1995	The AJA Scholarship begins, run with the AJ Cultural & Educational Fund, for students of Jamaican heritage in metro Atlanta and in Jamaica.[3]
2016	The start of a run that has since reached $200K in scholarships and aid for students.[4]
2021	Rep Yuh Parish launches, with members funding projects in their home parishes in Jamaica.[5]
2026	A sold-out Independence Ball and Scholarship Awards under the theme "Jamaica 64: A Legacy of Resilience", and a new Tony Gray Memorial Scholarship.[6]



The AJA already invests in students on both sides of the water. Hack876 is one more place where that support shows up for young Jamaicans.

04 THE SCHOOL NETWORK

9 schools. One room.

Evette Taylor-Reynolds began a teaching career at Campion College, according to the 2026 Marcus Garvey Symposium programme. Both Hack876 organisers are Campion alumni. Campion has confirmed its participation in Hack876.[7]

Hack876 begins with the schools where we already have relationships and can coordinate most reliably for the inaugural staging. Formal confirmations are still in progress, and the network is not an exclusive eligibility list.

- Hillel Academy
- Campion College
- Jamaica College
- Immaculate Conception High School
- Wolmer's
- Ardenne High School
- American International School of Kingston
- St. Andrew High School for Girls
- St. George's College

There are two natural homes for this inside the AJA.

The AJA meets on the second Saturday of each month at 6:00 p.m., except August and December, and welcomes all. The President can be reached at president@atlantajamaicanassociation.org.[2]

ASSOCIATION

An AJA special award

- Contribute toward a special award
- A proposed AJA Culture Award, if it fits
- Routed through whichever AJA entity suits the purpose
- Small, specific and easy to report back to members

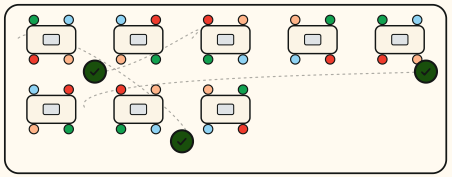
MEMBERS

The diaspora in the room

- Members as remote judges and mentors
- A short video message from the AJA to the students
- A slot at a monthly meeting to share what students built
- Two Hack876 organisers are Georgia Tech alumni and would gladly join a meeting

The AJA's contribution does not have to be purely financial.

People in the room.



01
Diaspora judges

Members with tech, business or education experience who score projects remotely or on the day.

02
Mentors

Remote mentors who help teams get unstuck, without building the project for them.

03
A message from Atlanta

A short recorded welcome from the AJA, so students know the diaspora is watching.

04
Award criteria

The Cultural Committee could help shape what a Culture award should reward; the judging panel makes the final call.

05
Storytellers

Share the winning builds with members at a monthly meeting or in AJA news.

GROUND RULES WE WILL HOLD OURSELVES TO

No marketing, membership drives or fundraising aimed at students, and no sign-ups on the day.

No collection of student contact details or data by partners. Photos and names only with school and parent consent.

Anyone volunteering in person follows our safeguarding rules and is never alone with students; the judging panel decides every award.

Become a Bronze Partner of the inaugural Hack876.

J$50,000 to below J$200,000

BRONZE PARTNER · INAUGURAL HACK876

It is small and concrete, close in spirit to the scholarships the AJA already gives, and it lets members see exactly what their support did.

Any amount within the level is welcome. It is a flexible contribution toward the event, with no naming rights attached.

PROPOSED RECOGNITION

The Atlanta Jamaican Association, Inc.

Bronze Partner · Inaugural Hack876

Closest Hack876 tracks: Culture, Learn, Life

CONTRIBUTION LEVELS. ANY AMOUNT WITHIN A LEVEL IS WELCOME.

Bronze Partner	Silver Partner	Gold Partner	Platinum Partner
SUGGESTED			
J$50,000 to below J$200,000	J$200,000 to below J$500,000	J$500,000 to below J$1,000,000	J$1,000,000+

In-kind & Community Support: devices, gift cards, meals, refreshments, supplies, connectivity, expertise, and contributions below J$50,000.

08 CONTRIBUTION LEVELS

What each level receives.

Bronze Partner

J$50,000 to below J$200,000

OUR SUGGESTION

- Recognition on the Hack876 website
- Included in the grouped sponsor thank-you
- Named in the post-event recap

Silver Partner

J$200,000 to below J$500,000

- Everything in Bronze
- Placement on event signage
- Acknowledgement in the opening and closing

Gold Partner

J$500,000 to below J$1,000,000

- Everything in Silver
- More prominent placement
- A dedicated sponsor feature
- Logo on event shirts, if shirts are produced*

Platinum Partner

J$1,000,000+

- The most prominent sponsor placement
- An agreed opportunity to take part in the programme
- Logo on event shirts, if shirts are produced*

These are proposed benefits, to be agreed when a sponsorship is confirmed. A sponsor can contribute any amount within a band.

*Shirt placement applies only if event shirts are produced and artwork arrives before the production deadline.

Speaking, mentoring, presenting an award and judging are subject to suitability and programme capacity. Sponsorship does not buy influence over judging, and no level carries naming rights.

09 WHERE A CONTRIBUTION GOES

No contribution has to cover a whole cost.

WHAT A CONTRIBUTION COULD SUPPORT

- **Special awards.** Helps support an existing special award.
- **Programming.** Helps support mentoring, judging and the student programme.

A sponsor can support the event overall, or agree a specific use with the Hack876 team. No contribution has to cover a whole cost.

In-kind & Community Support

For devices, gift cards, meals, refreshments, supplies, connectivity, expertise, and for contributions below J$50,000.

A meaningful in-kind contribution can be recognized at an equivalent level, based on a usable value agreed together. The advertised value of software credits or volunteer hours is not counted as cash automatically.

AN IDEA, NOT YET A HACK876 AWARD

AJA Culture Award (proposed)

A suggestion only: an award for the build that best celebrates or carries forward Jamaican culture, language or heritage, with criteria agreed together. It would echo the cultural programmes the AJA already runs.

10 A DIRECT LINE

There is no faceless sponsorship process here.

This proposal is for **Evette Taylor-Reynolds, President, The Atlanta Jamaican Association, Inc.**.[1]

If the AJA is interested, we can decide together what involvement should actually look like.

QUESTIONS WE WOULD ANSWER TOGETHER

- ✓ Which AJA entity would the support come from, and how does it reach Jamaica?
- ✓ Who are the students, and will Campion College take part?
- ✓ When is it, and how much lead time does the board need?
- ✓ Can members take part from Atlanta?
- ✓ How would a Culture award be judged, and who decides?
- ✓ How are students protected on consent, data and marketing?

A conversation, not a workload.

Deliberately focused.

Our vision is national. This inaugural staging does not have national-event resources, and we will not pretend it does.

Approximately 80 students. A school network of 9 in Kingston. One day, done properly.

Build the first one well.
Learn from it.
Earn the right to make the second one bigger.

2027

Help make the first Hack876 happen.

No multi-year commitment required.

FUTURE POSSIBILITIES, ONLY IF BOTH SIDES FIND IT VALUABLE. NOT COMMITMENTS.

- A recurring AJA award at every Hack876.
- Pointing eligible finalists heading to college toward the AJA Scholarship, on its usual terms.
- A Hack876 moment at the AJA Independence Ball & Scholarship Awards.
- Rep Yuh Parish teams picking up a student build that could help their parish.
- A special award to mark the AJA's 50th anniversary.



HACK876 × THE ATLANTA JAMAICAN ASSOCIATION, INC.

Somewhere in that room may be a future founder, engineer, designer or leader.

They do not need us to decide who they become.

They need an opportunity to begin.

HELP US BUILD THAT OPPORTUNITY.

We would love to explore the right first step with Evette and the Atlanta Jamaican Association family.

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hack876.com info@hack876.com

SOURCES

1. Atlanta Jamaican Association, "2026 Board of Directors." www.atlantajamaicanassociation.org/board
2. Atlanta Jamaican Association, "About Us: mission, history, lasting impact, meetings and contact." www.atlantajamaicanassociation.org/about-1
3. Atlanta Jamaican Association, "The AJA Scholarship." www.atlantajamaicanassociation.org/scholarship
4. Atlanta Jamaican Association, "Home: our impact." www.atlantajamaicanassociation.org/
5. Atlanta Jamaican Association, "Our Impact: outreach to Jamaica and Rep Yuh Parish." www.atlantajamaicanassociation.org/our-impact
6. Atlanta Jamaican Association, "News & Events: highlights from the 2026 Independence Ball & Scholarship Awards." www.atlantajamaicanassociation.org/news
7. Big Bethel AME Church, "3rd Annual Atlanta Marcus Garvey Symposium programme (March 25, 2026): AJA President bio." www.bigbethelame.org/_files/ugd/c3808e_8b54c0820b7d448a902c52ad3ee5df95.pdf

A private partnership proposal prepared for Evette Taylor-Reynolds, President, The Atlanta Jamaican Association.